

Tips & Tricks

Hidden things you didn't know about Whatsapp, live streaming, and your PC's cable management woes

**PS4 already profitable**

Sony's latest console is already profitable, expected to beat the sales record of PS2: <http://digit.in/RlyQ65>

Laptop hard drive woes, upgrading RAM, overclocking, and restoring Windows

We try to highlight readers' PC problems and help them with troubleshooting

Q Laptop HDD woes

Hi Digit,

I just want to know that laptop hard disk can be fixed or not. It takes a lot of time to start my laptop and writing and reading speed is around 2-3 kbps. Can you please try and tell me what is the reason for all this and how to solve the problem I'm encountering? Thanks.

—Ayush Agarwal

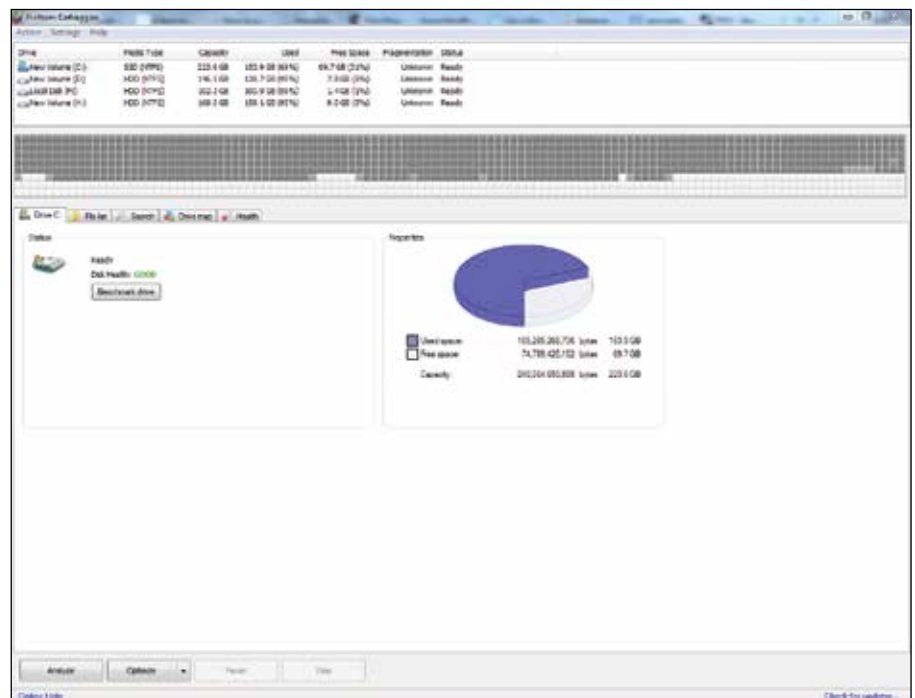
A Yes, laptop hard drives are the same as desktop hard drives and require just as much maintenance as their desktop variants to ensure a long working life and good transfer speeds. Generally, it is great to start off with a round of disk cleanup and removing unwanted programs (by uninstalling them properly, and not just deleting their installed folders). Then you'd want to run an anti-virus (download AVAST free edition, if you don't have one) and other anti-malware software to clean up any infections, if they do exist. Finally, run a good defragmentation software to sort everything in your hard drives physical sectors.

We do feel that the 2-3kbps transfer speed is a bit exaggerated but the above steps should help speed things up. Also, a remote possibility exists that your hard drive may conk off any time and this is the first signal of its oncoming death, so taking a backup of your data would be prudent and advisable.

Q Overclocking help

Hey Digit,

I have an issue with my trusty old laptop. It is a machine with the Acer's "InsydeH2O Setup Utility, V1.13" BIOS. I want to overclock my machine for slightly better performance, because I'm experiencing some performance bottlenecks.



Disk defragmentation is a tried and tested method of maintaining your hard drive's health

I hope I'll get help from you guys.
Thanks and Regards.

—Mukul Garg

A Firstly, it isn't advised to overclock your laptop since they don't have adequate cooling to handle the extra heat that will be generated upon overclocking. Secondly, unless your BIOS explicitly allows overclocking it is not possible to do so. If your laptop uses an Intel processor then you need to have the appropriate chipset on your laptop. Overclocking requires access to a lot of parameters which are only found in the BIOS. Simple overlocks which involve changing the CPU RATIO will work if you've been given access to change the same. If you have a discrete graphics

solution then you can easily overclock it using MSI Afterburner or ASUS GPU Tweak. Again, doing so is not recommended for laptops and you do risk causing permanent damage to your device. Instead, you should focus on maintaining your laptop better in order to get the most that it can offer.

Q Upgrading RAM

I want to upgrade my laptop with 4GB RAM. Right now I'm having Acer Travel-mate 5744 laptop which is working fine, so I am planning to upgrade the RAM to its maximum capacity. I just found that it consists of RAM modules which runs at 667MHz. My query to you is this: Is it possible that if I pair 1333 MHz or higher frequency RAM with previous one will it